

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 5 4 2

♥ 5 4

♦ K Q 4 3

♣ 9 6 5

♠ K 9 6 3

♥ A 7

♦ J 10 9

♣ A J 10 7



♠ 8

♥ J 10 6 3 2

♦ A 8 5

♣ 8 4 3 2

♠ Q J 10 7

♥ K Q 9 8

♦ 7 6 2

♣ K Q

When you have two 4-card suits to show you bid them "up-the-line". In this case it means you say 1♥. Partner replies 1♠.

There are enough points for game and a known 8-card Major fit. So you bid 4♠.

Perfect bidding isn't always rewarded. They can win three ♦ tricks and the Ace of trumps. If the opening lead is a ♥ or a ♣ you might make it, so it just depends on luck.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

Pass

1♥

Pass

1♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

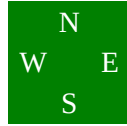
4♠ by North

Board 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 8 7 3
♥ A 8 5 3
♦ J 10 5
♣ 4 2

♠ K 10 4
♥ J 9 7
♦ A K 7 2
♣ K 5 3



♠ A J 5
♥ K 10 6
♦ Q 9 8 6
♣ A 9 6

♠ Q 6 2
♥ Q 4 2
♦ 4 3
♣ Q J 10 8 7

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

You have two very good choices, neither of which is really wrong. You could bid 2NT, showing 13-16 points, balanced, or you could bid 3♦, showing 13-16 points, good trump support.

What should decide you is the bidding priorities. You'd much rather try to play a 9-trick game than an 11-trick game. And at the same time you must trust your partner not to leave you hung out in Notrump with an unsuitable hand. (Can you believe I wrote Notrump and unsuitable in the same sentence?)

Anyway, you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.